

Shamak Gowda

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Expected Graduation: Spring 2028

Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

GPA: 4.00/4.00

- **Societies:** Regents' and Chancellor's Scholar (merit scholarship offered to top 0.1% applicants), Eta Kappa Nu (HKN), Institute of Electrical & Electronics Engineers (IEEE), Dean's List (top 10% in Engineering), Model United Nations
- **Courses:** Data Structures & Algorithms, Robotics, Machine Learning, Machine Structures (C, RISC-V), Discrete Mathematics and Probability Theory, Intro to CS (Python, SQL), Linear Algebra, Signals & Systems, Circuits

EXPERIENCE

Berkeley Artificial Intelligence Research (BAIR) Laboratory

Researcher, AUTOLab for Robotics and Automation Sciences (Prof. Ken Goldberg)

Jan. 2026 – Present

- Build robotics software spanning robot learning (VLAs, dynamics models), perception, motion planning, and closed-loop control across industry-sponsored research projects (Nvidia, Bosch, Samsung), from simulation to robot deployment;
- Fine-tuned autonomous-driving VLAs (SFT) to achieve 80% improved success rate on custom CARLA dynamic-obstacle parking testbed; implemented hybrid A* search and Kalman-filtering for ground-truth PDM trajectory data collection.
- Optimized agentic robotics for real-world industrial tasks via LLM-compatible robotics skills and motion-planning & perception suites; leveraged prompt-engineered agentic workflow (SKILL.md-defined skills, agents, coordinators) to design a Graph-as-Policy architecture for a novel bimanual handover task in a custom MuJoCo sim environment
- [IROS 2026]. Deployed a vision pipeline to disambiguate monochrome cables via specialized interaction primitives.
- Developed dynamics models to map robot actions in sim (Newton) to real-world hose deformations (Samsung Research)

Researcher, Berkeley Speech Group

Sep. 2025 – Mar. 2026

- Implemented a modular 4-stage pipeline integrating speech models to automate guitar audio-to-tablature transcription
- [Accepted to ISMIR 2026]. Integrated a high-resolution CRNN, CNN-BiLSTM technique classifier, multimodal T5 encoder-decoder & automated score generator into a unified transcription framework (achieved novel 72% oracle F1).
- Performed data consolidation and scripting and completed user-ready tool, code, and model release (HuggingFace)

CTRL Robotics (*startup*)

Jan. 2026 – May 2026

ROS Developer Intern

- Configured a control client for a mobile robot platform using ROS2 (Iron), Open-RMF & MQTT to bridge incoming telemetry with multi-floor hospital infrastructure; validated message flows (Postman) and action states (MongoDB)
- Engineered a multi-threaded Python simulator to mock real-time MQTT sensor statuses and queuing behaviors; eliminated hardware dependencies by deploying Docker and Multipass (Ubuntu) environments for 30% reduced test time.

Auriga Space

Jan. 2026 – May 2026

Electronics Engineer Contractor

- Built a flight-ready custom sensors board with robust flight hardware, sensing, and actuation, considering both thermals and stress under high-pressure and force environments. Configured communication with an external receiver
- Presented weekly with upper management, conducted design reviews, and delivered professional documentation

MIT Lincoln Laboratory

Jul. 2024 – Aug. 2024

Research Intern

- Architected an autonomous path-planning state space using ROS2; tuned and implemented closed-loop heading ($\pm 2^\circ$ accuracy) and depth PID controllers and developed maneuver strategies validated via Gazebo simulation
- Trained and optimized a YOLOv8 object detection model achieving 90% accuracy to track competing vehicles; deployed the computer vision pipeline onto a resource-constrained Raspberry Pi, managing edge inference constraints at 5 FPS.

FoodWare (*startup*)

Sep. 2024 – Apr. 2025

Front-end Developer Intern

- Developed a user-facing platform via React, Tailwind for a sustainability startup, displaying real-time reuse metrics that maximized platform efficiency by 2x. Utilized Axios to orchestrate asynchronous HTTP requests from AWS cloud API.
- Engineered secure iOS mobile checkout workflows by integrating the Stripe SDK; top 2 contributor on 0.7.0 release
- Built end-to-end wildfire prediction system with satellite imagery and LSTM models (88% accuracy). Designed RESTful API to perform CRUD operations to serve +1 million potential users & dynamic visualizations for long-term monitoring

PROJECTS

Alloy Crack Susceptibility Prediction | *Python, TensorFlow, Data Structures*

June 2023 – Aug. 2023

- Built a multi-model ML ensemble pipeline to predict solidification cracking susceptibility (SCS) in high-temperature aerospace alloys directly from elemental formula inputs. Achieved Pearson R of 0.75, minimizing variance over baselines

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java (Structures), Python, C/C++, RISC-V, SQL (Postgres), JavaScript, HTML/CSS, LaTeX, Bash, Dockerfile

Tools: Git, PyTorch, NumPy, Pandas, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, ROS2, React, Node.js, KiCAD, OpenCV, Docker, Microsoft